

Forged in the Fire, LLC

Forged in the Fire, LLC is a survivor-centered nonprofit organization dedicated to empowering victims and survivors of commercial sex trafficking through trauma-informed victim advocacy, workforce development, and leadership pathways. Grounded in survivor leadership, the organization creates sustainable opportunities for healing, economic stability, and systemic change by supporting survivors in becoming certified advocates themselves.



Based in Ohio, Forged in the Fire addresses a critical statewide gap in long-term, survivor-led solutions to human trafficking. The organization operates at the intersection of direct victim services, workforce development, and prevention—ensuring survivors are not only supported in crisis but equipped for long-term independence and leadership.

Founder & Executive Leadership

Tracy Springford, B.A., C.A.
Founder, President & CEO



Tracy Springford is a nationally recognized victim advocate specializing in crisis intervention for survivors of sexual assault and commercial sex trafficking. She brings more than **15 years of direct service experience** in anti-human trafficking work, including **over a decade in California**, where she conducted extensive community outreach and professional training for businesses, schools, law enforcement agencies, and public and private organizations.

Tracy currently serves as the **designated Victim Advocate** for the **Northeast Ohio Human Trafficking Task Force**, where she actively participates in statewide sting operations, search warrants, and arrest operations—providing immediate, trauma-informed advocacy to victims during law enforcement actions.

She holds a **Bachelor of Arts**, is a **Certified Victim Advocate through the National Advocate Credentialing Program (NACP)**, a **Registered Advocate through Ohio Victim Advocates**, and has completed **over 500 hours of specialized training** in trauma response, sexual assault, and human trafficking. Tracy is also recognized as an **expert court witness**, frequently testifying on the psychological, social, and community impacts of human trafficking.

Programs & Services

Forged in the Fire delivers comprehensive, trauma-informed services designed to support survivors at every stage of recovery and reintegration, including:

- **Trauma-Informed Victim Advocacy**
Immediate and ongoing support for victims and survivors navigating crisis response, legal systems, and recovery services that includes re-victimization prevention.
- **Advocate Trainee Workforce Development Program**
A paid training program that equips survivors with professional skills, certifications, and lived-experience leadership pathways to become certified victim advocates.
- **Survivor-to-Advocate Mentorship**
Peer-led mentorship fostering empowerment, leadership development, and sustainable career placement.
- **Community Education & Prevention Initiatives**
Training and awareness programs for communities, professionals, and organizations to prevent exploitation and identify trafficking.
- **Offender Accountability & Rehabilitation Services**
Court-aligned **Sex Buyers Education** programming focused on accountability, harm reduction, and prevention of re-offense.

Victim-Centered Organizational Statement

Although Forged in the Fire, LLC facilitates a **Sex Buyer Education (SBE)** program, we remain a survivor-centered, victim-focused, and trauma-informed organization at our core. Our mission is rooted in the safety, dignity, and long-term healing of individuals harmed by commercial sexual exploitation.

We deliver SBE with the explicit purpose of disrupting demand for commercial sex. By addressing and reducing the buying of sex, we directly undermine the economic incentive that fuels trafficking and exploitation. When demand is reduced, traffickers lose the financial benefit that drives the coercion and abuse of women and girls in commercial sex.

This program is not designed to shift focus away from victims, but to prevent future victimization. Our work holds buyers accountable while centering survivors, promoting systemic change, and advancing a community response that prioritizes prevention, justice, and restoration.